

Morphosyntactic parallels between Ancient Armenian and Hurro-Urartian: Contact or coincidence?

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Guiding question



What do and what *can* we know
about the contact situation
between Armenian and
Hurro-Urtatian?

Overview

The Urartians: background

The Urartian language

Armenian and Urartian

‘Established’ Armenian–Urartian contact features

Morphosyntactic case study I: negation

Morphosyntactic case study II: *Suffixaufnahme*

Final thoughts

The Urartians

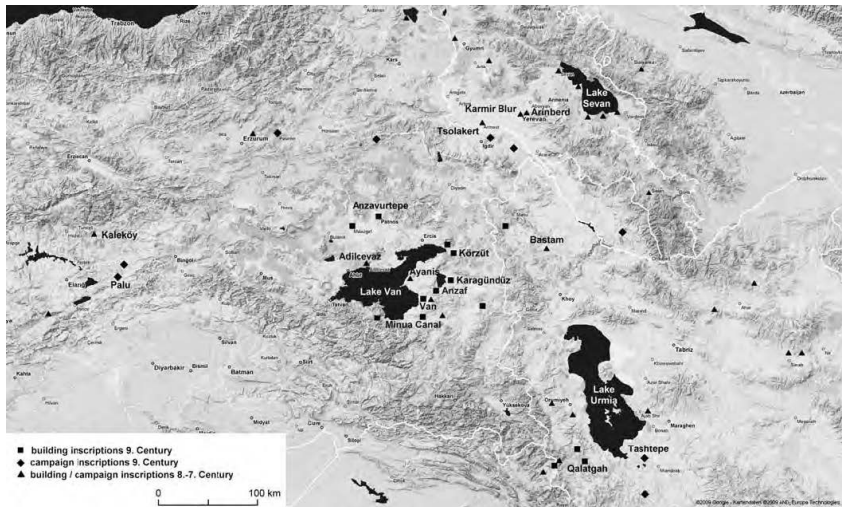


The Urartians: historical context

- ▶ historical kingdom of Eastern Anatolia, in competition with the Neo-Hittites and Neo-Assyrians
- ▶ written sources from the mid-9th to the mid-7th century BCE (some 700 inscriptions)
- ▶ earliest mention in 13th century BCE: Shalmaneser I (r. 1263–1234 BCE) claimed to have conquered the land *Ur(u)aṭri*
- ▶ general information severely limited by lack of sources
- ▶ main written documents include building and military campaign inscriptions, some texts of a cultic nature
- ▶ compared to other civilisations of this region and era, no material on law, education, poetry, or myth

(SALVINI 1995; WARTKE 1993; ZIMANSKY 1995)

The Urartians: geography



The Urartians: naming

And the ark rested in the seventh month, on the seventeenth day of the month, upon the mountains of Ararat. (Gen. 8:4)

And it came to pass, as he was worshipping in the house of Nisroch his god, that Adram-melech and Sharezer his sons smote him with the sword: and they escaped into the land of Ararat. And Esarhaddon his son reigned in his stead. (2 Kings 19:37 = Isa. 37:38)

(MARINKOVIĆ 2012)

The Urtarians: naming

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Endonym: *Biani(li)* ‘the people/language of the land of Bia (i.e. Van)’

Exonym: *Urtartu* (Assyrian), reinterpreted as *Ararat* by the Masoretes

(MARINKOVIĆ 2012)



What about the Urartian language and its history?

Uartian: phylogeny

- ▶ Uartian is generally held to have only one relative, Hurrian, with which it forms the Hurro-Uartian family.
- ▶ Hurrian was spoken in the late third and second millennium BCE, in a region partly overlapping with that later held by the Uartians.
- ▶ Uartian has a more complex phonological system than Hurrian
- ▶ both languages exhibit:
 - ▶ agglutinative morphology;
 - ▶ explicitly transitive-intransitive marking on the verb;
 - ▶ (more or less developed) ergative-absolutive alignment;
 - ▶ etc.
- ▶ next to linguistic relationships, both peoples share a (differently set up) pantheon, with Haldi, Teišeba (Teššub) and Šiuini (Šimigi) as key deities.

(CAMPBELL 2007; HAZENBOS 2005; SALVINI AND WEGNER 2014; WEGNER 2007)

Urtian: nominal morphology

	Hurrian		Urtian	
	SG	PL	SG	PL
ABS	-Ø	-lə	-Ø	-Ø, -lla
ERG		-š(ə)	-š	-(a)šuš
GEN	-i	-wə	-fe, -we	-(a)še
DAT	-ə	-wə	-fa, -wa	-(a)ša
ALL		-edə	-ta	-(a)šta
COM		-ranə	-ra	-(a)šura
INS		-nə	-ae	?
ABL	-danə	-š-tanə	-tan	-(a)štan
LOC		-a	-a	-(a)ša, -a

(Selection; some cases may be referred to by different names in the literature.)

Urartian: writing system



(Erebuni Museum, Yerevan = eCUT A 08-19)

Urtian: example

- (1) *ḫaldi-e euri-e ini Ê | argišti-še minua-hi-ni-še | šidišt-u-ni Ê.GAL*
 PN-DAT lord-DAT DEM house PN-ERG PN-GEN-CON-ERG build-TR-3SG_A.3SG_O fortress
badusi-e | ter-u-bi erbuni-ni tini | biaina-ue ušmaše
 perfection-DAT give-TR-1SG_A.3SG_O PN-DET? name Bia_lands-GEN.PL protection
 ‘To Ḫaldi, [his] Lord, Argišti, son of Menua, built this fortress. I gave it the name Erebuni,
 [for] the protection of the Bia lands’ (eCUT A 08-19)

A Northeast Caucasian language?

- ▶ Diakonoff and Starostin propose that Hurro-Urartian forms a branch of the North East Caucasian languages.
- ▶ This analysis is based on numerous supposed shared etyma and regular sound correspondences as well as some morphological observations.

Some examples:

- ▶ Urart. *pîlā* ‘canal’ < PEC *^ʔi-pîl₁V, cf. Avar-Andic *pula* ‘pipe’, Tsez *pelu* ‘(reed-)pipe’, Chechen *āpari* ‘wooden mill gutter’
- ▶ Urart. *burg-ana-* ‘building’ < PEC *p-or9wV, cf. Hinuq *bey* ‘stable’, Andic and Akhwakh *boryo*, Karata *beywa* ‘shed’
- ▶ Urart. *at-* ‘to destroy’ < PEC *^ʔāt₁wV, cf. Lezgian *g-ata-z* ‘to beat, forge, chop’, Rutul *-eta-s*, Dargwa *-it-es* ‘to beat’, Chechen *āta* ‘to crumble, to chop’

(DIAKONOFF 1971; DIAKONOFF AND STAROSTIN 1986)

Hurro-Urartian and PEC

HU

EC

- | | |
|---|--|
| 1. Absolute: -∅ | -∅ |
| 2. Ergative: *-s(∅) ^{a)} | * <u>s</u> ·V (ergative or instrumental) |
| 3. Genitive: * <u>-we</u> ^{b)} | PAnd * <u>-u</u> (relative) |
| 4. Dative: * <u>-wa</u> ^{c)} | * <u>-w₁</u> V (dative?) |
| 5. Directive (allative): * <u>-da</u> or * <u>-ta</u> | * <u>-t'a</u> or * <u>-da</u> (allative) ^{d)} |
| 6. Ablative: * <u>-n(∅)</u> ^{e)} | * <u>-nV</u> (ablative or genitive) |
| 7. Locative: * <u>-a</u> ^{f)} | * <u>-'V</u> (locative - inessive) |
| 8. Comitative: * <u>-ra</u> ^{g)} | * <u>-ra</u> (a conjunctive particle) |
| 9. Locative-illative(?): * <u>-(a)č_∅</u> ^{h)} | * <u>-čV</u> (locative-contactive) |
| 10. Prelative: * <u>-k(.)a(i)</u> ⁱ⁾ | * <u>-kk·V</u> (contactive) |

- Owing to the limited number of texts, our imperfect understanding, and a number of issues in historical phonology and morphology, Hurro-Urartian is not generally accepted as pertaining to the Northeast Caucasian family.



To what extent were Uartian
and Armenian in contact?

Armenian & Urtian: history

*In the Behistun inscription [...], the name of Armenia is still represented in Babylonian as “Urartu,” and one Armenian is named Haldita, a word that probably means “servant of Haldi.” Haldi was the chief divinity of the Urartean pantheon, so it is possible that Haldita’s parents had been worshippers of the Urartean god. The Armenian words for plum, apple, and mulberry (salor, khndzor, and tut), fruits native to the Armenian plateau, are also from the non-Indo-European Hurro-Urartean. Had the Armenians been living in Anatolia as long as the Hurro-Urartians, probably they would have had native, Indo-European words for these fruits. **More likely, they settled and learned the names of these fruits from the older, settled population who cultivated them.*** (RUSSELL 1997:23)

- ▶ establishing direct historical connections between Armenians and Urtians is difficult
- ▶ beyond anthroponyms (*Haldita*, *Arcruni*) and toponyms (*Van*, *Erevan*, *Tosp*, *Gar̄ni*, etc.) and a few loanwords, little is certain
- ▶ the situation is not helped by the general uncertainty regarding Indo-European migration, the unreliability of ancient sources, and modern quasi-nationalist narratives

Armenia: maps

Armenia in c. 70 BCE

- Armenian Empire
- Parthian Empire



Armenia: maps

Armenia in c. 379 CE

- Kingdom of Armenia
- Roman Province Armenia Minor
- Sasanian Empire



Armenian = / ≠ Urtian ?!

*[T]he most easily identifiable ancestors of the later Armenian nation are the Urtians. **It would be wrong to regard the society and culture of Urtu**, a powerful state between the ninth and early sixth centuries BC, situated where those Armenians referred to by Darius and Hecataeus lived, **as an Armenian achievement. But it would be equally wrong to regard Urtu as external to Armenian history.** Urtian culture was part of the Armenians' early experience, and late Urtian history was partly shaped by Armenians. Indeed, **this early period, when Urtu was a world power, should be considered one of the highest points in Armenian history**, rivalled only by the first century BC when the Armenian king Tigranes the Great forged a great, but short-lived, empire stretching down to Syria and the Holy Land.* (REDGATE 1998:5)

*[T]he history of the Armenian people should not begin with the post-Urtian period, **but should also include the period of Urtu and pre-Urtian states** (PETROSYAN 2018:179).*

Speaking Armenian

Ἰστοροῦσι δὲ τὴν Ἀρμενίαν μικρὰν πρότερον οὕσαν αὐξηθῆναι διὰ τῶν περὶ Ἀρταξίαν καὶ Ζαρίαδριν, οἱ πρότερον μὲν ἦσαν Ἀντιόχου τοῦ μεγάλου στρατηγοί, βασιλεύσαντες δ' ὕστερον μετὰ τὴν ἐκείνου ἦτταν ὁ μὲν τῆς σωφηνῆς καὶ τῆς Ἀκισηνῆς καὶ Ὀδομαντίδος καὶ ἄλλων τινῶν ὁ δὲ τῆς περὶ Ἀρτάξατα, συνηύξησαν ἐκ τῶν περικειμένων ἐθνῶν ἀποτεμόμενοι μέρη, ἐκ Μήδων μὲν τὴν τε Κασπιανὴν καὶ Φαυνίτιν καὶ Βασοροπέδαν, [...] ὥστε πάντα ὁμογλώττους εἶναι. (Strabo, *Geographica* XI.14.5)

According to report, Armenia, though a small country in earlier times, was enlarged by Artaxias and Zariadris, who formerly were generals of Antiochus the Great, but later, after his defeat, reigned as kings (the former as king of Sophenê, Acisenê, Odomantis, and certain other countries, and the latter as king of the country round Artaxata), and jointly enlarged their kingdoms by cutting off for themselves parts of the surrounding nations,—I mean by cutting off Caspianê and Phaunitis and Basoropeda from the country of the Medes; [...] and therefore they all speak the same language, as we are told. (trans. H. L. Jones)

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Implication: Uartian still spoken till then

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‘Established’ Armenian–Urtian contact features

- ▶ Although both Hurrian and Urtian had been (partly) deciphered already in the 19th century, renewed interest arose only in the 1980s
- ▶ this is also the time period for increased proposals of Hurro-Urtian loans in Armenian
- ▶ most proposed loans relate to endemic flora and fauna, and are few in number
- ▶ this suggests limited, superficial contact at best

(DIAKONOV 1985; GREPPIN 1996; GREPPIN AND DIAKONOFF 1991; SIMON 2022)

Examples of proposed loan words

- ▶ Arm. *arciw* ‘eagle’ ⇐ Urt. *Aršibə* ‘the name of King Minua’s horse’
- ▶ Arm. *car* ‘tree’ ⇐ Urt. *šari* ‘orchard’
- ▶ Arm. *cov* ‘sea’ ⇐ Urt. *šuə* ‘lake’
- ▶ Arm. *san* ‘kettle, pot’ ⇐ Urt. *šani* ‘vessel, pot’
- ▶ Arm. *ult* ‘camel’ ⇐ Urt. *ultu* ‘id.’
- ▶ Arm. *xalot* ‘grape’ ⇐ Urt. *haluli* ‘vine, grape’
- ▶ Arm. *xnjor* ‘apple’ ⇐ Hurr. *hinzuri* ‘apple’

Problems with proposed loan words

- ▶ **Arm. *arciw* ‘eagle’** ⇐ **Uart. *Aršibə* ‘the name of King Minua’s horse’**
good IE etymology: *h₂rǵipyó- ‘eagle’, cf. Ved. *rjipyá-* ‘moving straight upwards; eagle’, Av. *ərəzifiīō.parəna-* ‘eagle-feathered’
- ▶ **Arm. *car* ‘tree’** ⇐ **Uart. *šari* ‘orchard’**
good IE etymology: *ǵerso-, cf. Gk. γέppov ‘different objects from wickerwork’, ON *kjarr* ‘shrubs’
- ▶ **Arm. *cov* ‘sea’** ⇐ **Uart. *šuə* ‘lake’**
good IE etymology: *ǵobh-u-, cf. Ir. *gó* ‘sea’, Olc. *kaf* ‘sea’, Lyd. *kofu-* ‘water’
- ▶ **Arm. *san* ‘kettle, pot’** ⇐ **Uart. *šani* ‘vessel, pot’**
- ▶ **Arm. *ult* ‘camel’** ⇐ **Uart. *ulṭu* ‘id.’**
Uartian word does not exist; partial reading ^{GU4}x-ṭu’-ni^{MEŠ}; wrong classifier (‘ox’), where ‘donkey’ expected
- ▶ **Arm. *xalot* ‘grape’** ⇐ ***ḫaluli* ‘vine, grape’**
- ▶ **Arm. *xnjor* ‘apple’** ⇐ **Hurr. *ḫinzuri* ‘apple’**

Urartian-Armenian loans

*While Armenian undoubtedly has a loanword layer from the Hurro-Urartian languages, [...] the number of assured borrowings is far less than previously thought: Out of more than forty proposals, less than one-fifth, i.e. **eight etymologies could be confirmed**. That said, the Armenian lexicon famously contains a huge number of words of unknown etymology and, therefore, one can surely claim that with the advancement of our knowledge of the Hurro-Urartian languages as well as of the history of Armenian, more loans will be revealed. (SIMON 2022:83)*

- ▶ Out of 17 hypothesised Armenian loans in Urartian, none have been deemed plausible.
- ▶ This directionality and lexical restriction has clear implications for the nature and extent of contact.



Are there any morphosyntactic
parallels between Urtian and
Armenian?

Negation in Urtian

- ▶ Urtian expresses negation both morphologically (bound morpheme) and syntactically
- ▶ there are two sets of negatives, declarative (*ui* + *-urə*) and prohibitive/vetitive (*mi* + *-unə*)

(2) *ust-a-və minua-ne ispuini-hə*
 campaign-INT-3SG_S PN-DET PN-POSS
 ‘Menua, son of Ispuini went on campaign’ (SALVINI 2008:I: 202)

(3) *ui ai-ne erilə istinə ust-(a)-urə*
NEG INDF-ABS king here campaign-INTR-**NEG**
 ‘No king campaigned here.’ (SALVINI 2008:I: 425)

(4) *man-inə istinə minua(-i) ardisə*
 be-JUSS here PN-GEN order
 ‘Let Menua’s order be here.’ (SALVINI 2008:I: 244)

(5) *mi-kui tini man-unə*
PROHIB-even name be-**VET**
 ‘Let not even his name remain.’ (SALVINI 2008:I: 579)

The Hurrian problem

- ▶ Some bound morphemes in Urtian have clear and phonologically unproblematic parallels in Hurrian that allow us to establish a PHU base form (tr. neg. *-wa-; vet. *-o-w(a)-en)
- ▶ a free, syntactic negation marker is missing in Hurrian, however
- ▶ *ui* and *mi* have no self-evident parallels in Hurrian (but *ui* also serves as NEG.INDF)

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Solution? Arm. *mi* (PROHIB) < **meh*₁

I explain the redundant pattern of Uartian negation as a product of language contact. Since Classical Armenian, like all the other ancient Indo-European languages, expresses verbal negation by syntactic means, the Uartian negative subparadigm must have represented a challenge for second language learners. If so, Proto-Armenians may have compensated by appending negative particles on top of the affirmative verbal forms.(YAKUBOVICH 2010:164)

CAMPBELL (2007); YAKUBOVICH (2010)

Issues

- ▶ As suggested above, evidence of substantial contact with Armenian is limited, and the direction of borrowing/interference normally inverse.
- ▶ Cp. also the question of CArm. *ew* and Urt. *euə* ‘and’.
- ▶ A morphosyntactic borrowing on this level is difficult to justify given the comparative data.

Alternative:

- ▶ If we assume this to be an internal development (type Jespersen’s Cycle), this would not be unusual.
- ▶ Negative morphemes in *-ma* exist in Hurrian (phonotactically conditioned allomorph of *-wa-*) as does the adversative particle *-man*, cp. Urt. *mi* ‘but’, *mi...mi* ‘neither ...nor’.
- ▶ Phonological and analogical changes seem a more plausible basis for explaining prohibitive *mi* than contact with Armenian.

Basic definition: *Suffixaufnahme*

The presence in a single word of what are seen as two inflections for case.

*A noun may be marked e.g. as adnominal; thus **Bill's** in **Bill's wife**. Call it 'genitive': **Bill-GEN wife**. In many languages, e.g. in Australia, an adnominal noun will also agree with the case of a noun on which it depends: e.g., if the word for 'wife' is dative, **Bill-GEN-DAT wife-DAT**. But 'genitive' is itself traditionally a case. Therefore, to the amazement of linguists who first came across such languages, they have nouns inflected for 'case' twice and not once.*

(MATTHEWS 2014)

Generalisation

(6) $NP_1\text{-suffix}_X$ $NP_2\text{-suffix}_Y\text{-suffix}_X$

- ▶ an agreement phenomenon largely associated with agglutinative languages
- ▶ geographically limited to two broad regions: the Caucasus & ancient Middle East; Australia
- ▶ typically limited to certain combinations with particular cases, most frequently with the genitive (and other expressions of possession)

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- ▶ typically limited to certain combinations with particular cases, most frequently with the genitive (and other expressions of possession)
- ▶ Some languages exhibiting *Suffixaufnahme*:
 - ▶ Old Georgian (BOEDER 1995)
 - ▶ Hurrian (WEGNER 2007:69–75)
 - ▶ Urtian (SALVINI AND WEGNER 2014:29–31)
 - ▶ Sumerian (PLANK 1995:40–1)
 - ▶ Elamite (PLANK 1995:42)
 - ▶ Kayardild (ROUND 2012:76–7, 189–99)
 - ▶ Lardil (RICHARDS 2013)
 - ▶ Alawa (PLANK 1995:43)
 - ▶ Laragia (PLANK 1995:49)

Classic Examples

- (7) *šečevn-ita čmid-isa sameb-isa-jta*
help-**INS** holy-GEN trinity-GEN-**INS**

“with the help of the Holy Trinity” (Old Georgian; Sos 1980 no. 2)

- (8) *sen(a)=iffu=ue=ne=z* *asti=i=z*
brother-1SG.POSS-GEN-CON-**ERG** wife-3SG.POSS-**ERG**

“the wife of my brother” (Hurrian; Mil. III 7)

- (9) *Ngada latha karnjin-i marun-ngan-ku maarn-ku*
1SG pierce wallaby-ACC son-GEN-**INS** spear-**INS**

“I’ve speared the wallaby with my son’s spear.” (Lardil; RICHARDS 2013:43)

Less prototypical examples exist elsewhere.

‘Suffixaufnahme’ in Armenian

There is a similar, non-obligatory double-marking pattern in Classical Armenian which *resembles* but is not identical to *Suffixaufnahme* as outlined above.

- (10) *covac’uc’anēr z=vardapetut’ean=n z=xorut’iwn*
dive.3SG.PST **OBJ**=teaching.GEN.SG=DET **OBJ**=depth.ACC.SG
“he dove into the depth of the teachings” (Koriwn (I) XVII.21)

The proclitic *z=* in Classical Armenian marks a definite / specified direct object and frequently co-occurs with the enclitic determinatives *=n,=d* or *=s*.

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Contrast:

- (11) NP₁-suffix_X NP₂-suffix_Y-suffix_X (*Suffixaufnahme*)
 (12) prefix_X-NP₁-suffix_X [...] prefix_X-NP₂-suffix_Y (*Präfixaufnahme*)

Issues

- ▶ not expected to exhibit this type of construction as an Indo-European language of the Caucasus with fusional/inflectional morphology:

- ▶ shows little morphosyntactic agreement in NPs elsewhere

but Armenian is a ‘sponge’, has absorbed many elements from surrounding contact languages

Question:

Could this construction be a remnant of contact with Urtian?

Morphosyntactic agreement

- (13) *p'arawk' mecawk'*
glory.INS.PL great.INS.PL
“with great glory”

► obligatory agreement of postposed adjectives

- (14) *mec c'asambk'*
great rage.INS.PL
“with great rage”

► agreement not necessary for preposed adjectives

- (15) *mecaw palatanawk'*
great.INS supplication.INS.PL
“with great supplications”

► preposed monosyllabic adjectives *tend* to show CASE but not NUMBER agreement

(KÖLLIGAN AND KIM fthc.)

Behaviour of the construction

Key questions to establish whether the Armenian construction behaves like its neighbours:

► **patterning**

Is the pattern restricted to essentially the same function as *Suffixaufnahme* or are there others?

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► **internal parallels**

Do other, similar repetitions occur with different markers, suggesting a potential common origin?

► **plausibility**

Is a language-internal explanation plausible or is contact a better fit – and if so, how?

Patterning: other types

Less relevant for the present question

- (16) *z=tēr mer z=Yisus K'ristos z=barerar=n z=sk'anč'elagorc=n [...]*
OBJ=Lord 1PL.POSS **OBJ**=PN PN **OBJ**=indulgent=DET **OBJ**=wondrous=DET
awrh nec'ak'
 praise.2PL.AOR

“We praised our indulgent and wondrous [...] Lord Jesus Christ” (simple repetition; Ag. CXVI.19)

- (17) *ew arnuin [...] z=Garni k'alak'=n, z=Ani=n, z=Artagers ...*
 and take.3PL.PST **OBJ**=PN town=DET **OBJ**=PN **OBJ**=PN

“And they took [...] the town of Garni, Ani, Artagers ...” (different objects; Elišē III.126)

Patterning: other types

More interesting for the present question

(18) prefix_X-NP₁-suffix_X [...] prefix_X-NP₂-suffix_Y

(19) *xoselov* *z=noc'anē* *z=amenayn č'arut'iwn*
tell.INF.INS PREP/**OBJ**=3PL.ABL **OBJ**=all malice.ACC.SG
“by relating all their malice” (non-ACC = ABL; Elišē III.234)

(20) *varesc'ē* *z=tiezerakan* *išxanut'iwn=d* *z=or* *awandēal ē*
use.3SG.AOR.SBJV **OBJ**=universal power.ACC.SG=DET **OBJ**=REL.NOM.SG give.PTCP be.3SG
dma *y=Astu(a)coy*
3SG.DAT from=god.ABL.SG
“he will use his universal power, which was given to him by God” (non-ACC = RC; Elišē II.130)

► Standard: ACC + GEN

► Marginal: ACC + ABL and ACC + REL

Patterning: corpus study

A corpus study (counting only repetitions with the same object NP):

- ▶ Koriwn, early 5th century (6'300 words) – 6.6/1'000
- ▶ Agat'angelos, mid-5th century (31'700 words) – 4.4/1'000
- ▶ P'awstos Buzand, late 5th century (62'600 words) – 6.4/1'000
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	Kor.	Ag.	P'B	Eł.
$z=X \ z=Y$	23	55	197	61
$z=X \ A \ z=Y$	15	59	141	43
$z=X \ A \ B \ z=Y$	4	26	63	14
Total	42	140	401	118

All repetitions

	Kor.	Ag.	P'B	Eł.
$z=X \ z=Y$	13 (59%)	11 (10%)	49 (25%)	9 (15%)
$z=X \ A \ z=Y$	8 (53%)	15 (25%)	34 (24%)	11 (26%)
$z=X \ A \ B \ z=Y$	4 (100%)	7 (27%)	19 (30%)	6 (43%)
Total	25 (59%)	34 (24%)	102 (25%)	26 (22%)

$NP_{ACC} + NP_{non-ACC}$ (%-age of total)

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Observations:

- ▶ general tendency of z =repetition decreases over time (sort of)
- ▶ repetitions with one NP in non-ACC are most frequent in earliest text
- ▶ possible correlation between distance of NPs (where one NP is non-ACC) and z = repetition

Internal Parallels

- ▶ Originally, the *nota accusativi* *z=* was a preposition (and can still serve as such)
- ▶ There are five other (simple) prepositions: *ar*, *and*, *əst*, *i/y=* et *c' =*.
- ▶ One might, therefore, assume that other prepositions could behave similarly as regards repetition.

Internal Parallels

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- ▶ There are five other (simple) prepositions: *ar*, *and*, *ast*, *i/y=* et *c'*.
- ▶ One might, therefore, assume that other prepositions could behave similarly as regards repetition.
- ▶ The fifth-century corpus shows that only *one* other preposition is *sometimes* repeated: *i/y=* (7 occurrences in the corpus).
- ▶ These repetitions do not occur with one NP in a case other than the expected.
- ▶ Repetition of prepositions as a general pattern is therefore unlikely to be the origin of double-marking in Armenian.

- (21) *i nerk's matuc'eal i srahs=n ark'uni*
PREP under advance.PTCP PREP chamber.ACC.PL=DET royal
“... he advanced into the royal chambers ...” (Elišē VII.257)

Internal development

Observation

- ▶ simple repetition (ACC + ACC) of the marker $z=$ is diachronically quite stable (still occurs in early Middle Armenian)
- ▶ the incidence of double-marking pattern decreases over time, already in the fifth century
- ▶ it remains more prevalent at longer distances (e.g. with two intervening words)

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Proposal

- ▶ both patterns (simple repetition and double-marking) essentially serve disambiguation
- ▶ neither is obligatory or fully grammaticalised (great internal variation)
- ▶ double-marking *is probably* a secondary development, an extension of the simple repetition to non-ACC constituents
- ▶ the latter remains marginal and loses traction over time

Outline

“I see the great men of God.”

Basic

es z={mec [...] mards [...] Astucoy}=n tesanem.

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Extension I: disambiguation after intervening words

es z={mec [...] (z=)mards [...] Astucoy}=n tesianem.

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Extension I: disambiguation after intervening words

es z={mec [...] (z=)mards [...] Astucoy}=n tesanem.

Extension II: inclusion of non-ACC constituents

es z={mec [...] (z=)mards [...] (z=)Astucoy}=n tesanem.

External influence?

- ▶ Old Georgian influence can *probably* be excluded – influence normally inverse (although there are certain parallels)
- ▶ Urtian influence could *theoretically* play a role – but how?
- ▶ There are no real structural nor phonological parallels (discounting YAKUBOVICH 2010).
- ▶ As we have seen, even lexical borrowing is limited / problematic.
- ▶ Claiming a vague ‘areal phenomenon’ based on bilingual Urtian–Armenian speakers and their awareness of double-marking is aetiologically unhelpful – even if it cannot be excluded.

Summary

- ▶ *Suffixaufnahme*, a morphosyntactic agreement pattern, is not widespread but well attested in the historical Caucasus and the Middle East.
- ▶ A similar – but not identical – phenomenon also occurs in Classical Armenian.
- ▶ The origin of this agreement pattern is unclear, but an internal development facilitating disambiguation might be the simplest explanation.
- ▶ Influence from a contact language cannot be excluded, *but* the mechanisms of this contact, e.g. with Urtarian, are unclear beyond a vague label of ‘areal phenomenon’.

Final thoughts

- ▶ On the basis of these two case studies, and the limited lexical correspondences we have seen, Uartian and Armenian have clearly been in contact.

BUT

- ▶ The two hypothesised or possible morphosyntactic parallels seem difficult to uphold (or indeed propose) given our imperfect understanding of Uartian, the limited lexical evidence for contact, and no-less-possible internal explanations.

Contact
Coincidence

Thank you for your attention!

Merci pour votre attention!

Շատ շնորհակալութիւնք Ձեր ուշադրութեան համար!

/ʃat ʃnorakalu't^hjun dʒer uʃadru't^hjan ha'mar/



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